# Contend for the Faith

Charts for the Epistle of Jude

Leader resource · Small Group Bible Study Series · NASB

The Gospel Vault

# Jude at a glance

*Survey chart · 25 verses, five movements*

| vv.1–2 | vv.3–4 | vv.5–16 | vv.17–23 | vv.24–25 |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Greeting** | **Purpose** | **Exposure** | **Exhortation** | **Doxology** |
| Called, beloved, kept | Contend for the faith | The intruders' character and doom | Remember, keep, show mercy | Him who is able to keep |

| vv.5–7 | vv.8–13 | vv.14–16 |
|---|---|---|
| Three examples | "These" exposed | Enoch's prophecy |

## Bookends — what Jude opens with, he closes with

### Kept
v.1 — kept for Jesus Christ
↕
v.24 — able to keep you

### The faith
v.3 — contend for the faith
↕
v.20 — build up on your most holy faith

### Mercy
v.2 — mercy be multiplied
↕
vv.21–23 — wait for mercy; show mercy

# Jude thinks in threes

*Triads across the letter*

| Ref | One | Two | Three |
|---|---|---|---|
| **v.1** | called | beloved in God the Father | kept for Jesus Christ |
| **v.2** | mercy | peace | love |
| **vv.5–7** | Israel in the wilderness | angels who left their abode | Sodom and Gomorrah |
| **v.8** | defile the flesh | reject authority | revile angelic majesties |
| **v.11** | the way of Cain | the error of Balaam | the rebellion of Korah |
| **v.19** | cause divisions | worldly-minded | devoid of the Spirit |
| **vv.20–21** | building yourselves up | praying in the Holy Spirit | keep yourselves in God's love |
| **vv.22–23** | have mercy on some who doubt | save others from the fire | on some have mercy with fear |
| **v.25** | before all time | now | forever |

# The "keep" bracket

*God keeps (vv.1, 24) · kept for judgment (vv.6, 13) · keep yourselves (v.21)*

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **v.1** | *"…called, beloved in God the Father, and kept for Jesus Christ"* | **τετηρημένοις**<br>tēreō · perf. pass. ptc. — kept by God; a settled, ongoing state |
| **v.6** | *"angels who did not keep their own domain… He has kept in eternal bonds"* | **τηρήσαντας · τετήρηκεν**<br>Those who would not keep their place are now kept under judgment |
| **v.13** | *"for whom the black darkness has been reserved forever"* | **τετήρηται**<br>perf. pass. ind. — the intruders' end is kept for them |
| **v.21** | *"keep yourselves in the love of God"* | **τηρήσατε**<br>aor. act. impv. 2nd pl. — a command for the believer's walk |
| **v.24** | *"Him who is able to keep you from stumbling… blameless with great joy"* | **φυλάξαι**<br>phylassō · aor. act. inf. — God guards His own to the end |

Security rests on God's keeping (vv.1, 24). "Keep yourselves" (v.21) is responsibility for the walk — inside that security.

# Three examples of judgment

*vv.5–7 · each points back to the intruders of v.4*

| Example | OT background | What they did | Outcome | Jude's point |
|---|---|---|---|---|
| **Israel (v.5)** | Num 14; cf. Heb 3:16–19 | Saved out of Egypt, then did not believe God at Kadesh | That generation died in the wilderness | Privilege does not exempt from judgment |
| **Angels (v.6)** | Gen 6:1–4 (common reading); 2 Pet 2:4 | Did not keep their own domain; abandoned their proper abode | Kept in eternal bonds under darkness for the great day | Rank does not exempt from judgment |
| **Sodom and Gomorrah (v.7)** | Gen 19 | Gross immorality; went after strange flesh | Exhibited as an example of eternal fire | Open rebellion stands as a public warning |

**v.4** *"certain persons have crept in unnoticed… ungodly persons who turn the grace of our God into licentiousness and deny our only Master and Lord, Jesus Christ."*

# Woe to them: three portraits

*v.11 · walked → rushed → perished*

## Cain

*"gone the way of"*

**Old Testament**
Gen 4:1–16 · Heb 11:4 · 1 John 3:12

**The sin**
Worship on his own terms; envy that ended in murder

**The pattern today**
Self-made religion that resents the righteous

## Balaam

*"for pay… rushed headlong into the error of"*

**Old Testament**
Num 22–24; 31:16 · 2 Pet 2:15 · Rev 2:14

**The sin**
Ministry for profit; led Israel into compromise

**The pattern today**
Using spiritual things for gain

## Korah

*"perished in the rebellion of"*

**Old Testament**
Num 16

**The sin**
Rose up against the God-appointed leadership of Moses and Aaron

**The pattern today**
Defying God-given authority (cf. v.8)

# "These" — text, then application

*Five times Jude cites a text, then says "these" (οὗτοι) to apply it*

| Text | "These" |
| --- | --- |
| **Text · vv.5–7**<br>Israel, angels, Sodom | **"These" · v.8**<br>defile the flesh, reject authority, revile majesties |
| **Text · v.9**<br>Michael and the body of Moses | **"These" · v.10**<br>revile what they do not understand |
| **Text · v.11**<br>Cain, Balaam, Korah | **"These" · vv.12–13**<br>hidden reefs at your love feasts |
| **Text · vv.14–15**<br>Enoch's prophecy | **"These" · v.16**<br>grumblers, fault-finders, flatterers |
| **Text · vv.17–18**<br>The apostles' warning | **"These" · v.19**<br>divisive, worldly-minded, devoid of the Spirit |

# Five pictures from creation

*vv.12–13 · sea, sky, land, and the heavens*



## Sea

*Hidden reefs at your love feasts; wild waves casting up their own shame like foam*

Unseen danger in the fellowship; restless lives that leave a mess behind



## Sky

*Clouds without water, carried along by winds*

Promise without delivery — they look like they bring rain, but bring none



## Land

*Autumn trees without fruit, doubly dead, uprooted*

No fruit at harvest time, and no root to bear any later



## Heavens

*Wandering stars, for whom the black darkness has been reserved forever*

No fixed course — useless for navigation, headed for darkness

# Jude and 2 Peter side by side

*Shared themes and order*

| Shared theme | Jude | 2 Peter |
|---|---|---|
| Intruders who deny the Master | v.4 | 2:1–3 |
| Angels held for judgment | v.6 | 2:4 |
| Sodom and Gomorrah | v.7 | 2:6 |
| Despise authority, revile majesties | v.8 | 2:10 |
| Angels refrain from reviling judgment | v.9 | 2:11 |
| Like unreasoning animals | v.10 | 2:12 |
| The error of Balaam | v.11 | 2:15 |
| Feasting with you; waterless clouds | v.12 | 2:13, 17 |
| Black darkness reserved | v.13 | 2:17 |
| Arrogant words | v.16 | 2:18 |
| Mockers in the last time | vv.17–18 | 3:2–3 |

# Where Jude and 2 Peter differ

*Same danger, different emphasis*

| Point | Jude | 2 Peter |
|---|---|---|
| **Timing** | The intruders have already crept in (v.4) | "There will also be false teachers" (2:1) |
| **Examples** | Judgment only — Israel, angels, Sodom; Cain, Balaam, Korah | Judgment and rescue — Noah in the flood, Lot from Sodom (2:5–9) |
| **Other sources** | Michael and Moses' body (v.9); Enoch's prophecy (vv.14–15) | No extra-biblical citations; the angel point is general (2:11) |
| **The call** | Contend; keep yourselves; rescue others (vv.3, 20–23) | Grow in grace and knowledge (3:18) |
| **Closing** | To Him who is able to keep you (vv.24–25) | To Him be the glory, now and to the day of eternity (3:18) |

# Jude's references outside the Old Testament

*vv.9 and 14–15 · what Jude is doing, and what he is not*

## v.9 Michael and the body of Moses

**Background**

Early writers (Clement of Alexandria, Origen) linked this to a Jewish work known as the Assumption (or Testament) of Moses; the surviving copy lacks its ending.

**Jude's point**

Even the archangel left judgment to God: "The Lord rebuke you" (cf. Zech 3:2).

## vv.14–15 Enoch's prophecy

**Background**

Closely matches 1 Enoch 1:9, a Jewish writing well known in Jude's day.

**Jude's point**

The Lord comes with His holy ones to judge the ungodly — "ungodly" four times in v.15.

### Quoting is not canonizing

Paul quoted Greek poets — Aratus (Acts 17:28), Epimenides (Titus 1:12), Menander (1 Cor 15:33). Inspiration guarantees that what Jude affirms is true, not that every book he draws from is Scripture.

# Him who is able to keep you

"…from stumbling, and to make you stand in the presence of His glory blameless with great joy." — Jude 24 (NASB)

**before all time**

**now**

**forever**

*Jude 25 — glory, majesty, dominion and authority*